

# Becoming the Therapist You Want to Be

*Confidence isn't an identity. It's a byproduct of becoming someone you trust.*

## THE IDEA

You don't decide one morning that you're a confident therapist. You become one by repeatedly behaving like the therapist you're trying to be: one boundary, one repair, one honest reflection at a time. Your identity catches up to your behavior, not the other way around.

## AIM FOR TRUSTWORTHY, NOT IMPRESSIVE

Impressive therapists want to sound smart, chase the perfect intervention, and perform certainty. Trustworthy therapists want to understand, pay attention, and can tolerate not knowing. Clients rarely remember your best reflection. They remember how it felt to be with you.

## HOW IDENTITY ACTUALLY FORMS

|                 |                                                                           |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>QUALITY</b>  | Pick one you want clients to experience, like grounded.                   |
| <b>BEHAVIOR</b> | Translate it into something you can do tomorrow: pause before responding. |
| <b>EVIDENCE</b> | Notice when you do it: "I stayed present instead of rushing."             |
| <b>IDENTITY</b> | Over time it becomes "I'm someone who stays grounded under pressure."     |

## ASK YOURSELF

Next time your brain says "I don't think I'm cut out for this," swap the question for: "Who am I practicing becoming?" Then name three qualities you want clients to feel from you, and one behavior for each that you can practice this week.

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*You don't become a trusted clinician by trying to feel like one. You become one by practicing the behaviors that make you trustworthy.*